NATIONAL REVENUE AUTHORITY
Republic of South Sudan
Office of the Board Chairperson

ADDRESS BY HON. STEPHEN DHIEU DAU, CHAIRPERSON OF THE NRA BOARD OF DIRCTORS TO MANAGERIAL STAFF OF THE NATIONAL REVENUE AUTHORITY(NRA) ON 15TH JUNE 2023

TALKING POINTS:

1. Brief self-introduction

2. The NRA is governed by the NRA Act, 2016, you managers are in charge of managing the day-to-day operations under the leadership of your CEO, who is Commissioner General (CG), and the Board of Directors is in charge of supervising you managers through your CG;

3. As recently reaffirmed by the Minister of Justice, the NRA Act, 2016, requires the Authority to hire its own employees, including even a consultant to assist in the process;

4. I would want to praise you for coming up with a very effective and concrete strategy, which the Board adopted in June 2022 and the Council of Ministers endorsed in September 2022; as you are all aware, we are currently implementing our first five-year strategic plan 2022 – 2027;

5. As you are also all aware, we pledged to the government and the citizens of our nation that we would boost non-oil revenue from an average monthly level of SSP 6.6 billion to SSP 31.5 billion under the Plan;

6. Allow me to take this opportunity to thank you once more for heading in the correct way by collecting SSP 170.6 billion for the entire eleven-month

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period of the FY 2022–2023 and achieving a monthly average of SSP 15.5 billion by May 2023;

7. As you can see, there is still more work to be done in order to realize our goal of collecting SSP 31.5 billion per month, or about 6% of our GDP;

8. The hiring of an adequate number of personnel with the necessary skills, expertise, and attitude is a vital success factor to achieving the NRA Vision, according to the Strategic Plan that you provided to the Board, and the Board agreed with you and recommended it for approval to the Cabinet;

9. You all know that the NRA Human Resource Policy, which was once again created by you and approved by the Board in April 2022, was also endorsed by the Council of Ministers in November 2022;

10. The Human Resource Policy has specified 1,552 job positions (NRA Scheme of Service), each of which comes with a competitive salary as well as the necessary training and experience for each and every position;

11. Please be advised that the Board will make sure that the hiring process is carried out in full compliance with Section 51 of the NRA Act, 2016. All vacancies will be posted publicly, and priority will be given to you, the present staff, if you meet the requirements in terms of education and experience;

12. In fact, the NRA Scheme of Service has formalized the aspect of prioritizing present staff in the process of recruitment into account by designating over 80% of all 1,552 positions for individuals with experience in tax or customs administration (assuming they possess the necessary qualifications);

13. This only suggests that some of you, the current staff, will occupy those roles if you also happen to have the necessary academic credentials and have expertise in tax or customs administration;

14. In this regard, I would like to encourage all present employees who do not have the required academic credentials to obtain them by the end of June 2025;

15. If not, any Customs or Taxation employees who were not hired by NRA will be sent back to their "mother" organizations in July 2025;

16. This means that regardless of whether you are hired by NRA in 2023, 2024, or 2025, you will all continue to work at NRA until the initial staffing exercise is complete, and that is when a total of 1,552 will have been recruited through a competitive and transparent process.

17. I've been informed that some of you have little or no faith in the hiring process. I want to reassure everyone in attendance, as well as your subordinate staff members who are not physically present here today, that the Board will take all necessary steps to ensure that the process is both open and equitable for all parties. No one will be harmed, but also be aware that nobody will be favored;

18. For this reason, the Board selected M/S Stirling Consultants Limited of Kenya, a renowned firm with extensive expertise in comparable tasks across the region, in a competitive selection process from among the 16 firms that had shown interest in this assignment, to fill the position of recruitment firm. Given that M/S Stirling Consultants Limited is a foreign company, I anticipate that applicants will be evaluated for each post solely on their merit;

19. Nevertheless, the firm won't be unchecked because it will be under the supervision of a High-Level Inter-Ministerial Technical Committee to make sure that it not only conducts its business professionally and independently but also abides by all applicable laws, such as the NRA Act of 2016 and the Civil Service Act of 2011;

20. The High-Level Inter-Ministerial Technical Committee, which will include representatives from the Ministries of Finance, Justice, Interior, Public Service, National Security, and NRA, will monitor the work of M/S Stirling Consultants Limited and advise the Board accordingly so that the Board

can make final appointments based on accurate and verifiable information;

21. **I've been told that some of you didn't apply for the managerial posts that have already been advertised because of the uncertainty surrounding the NRA hiring procedure, some as a result of false information on the exercise's legality, and some as a result of doubt about its fairness. Now, it has been decided to reopen up the application window for any staff members currently working for NRA, who did not apply but now wish to apply for any of the managerial posts already posted in order to give such people a chance that if missed will unfairly penalize them. The Consultant will be instructed to allow you to submit your application between June 19 and June 25, 2023, following which time, suitable candidates will be short-listed;**

22. Let us not let our heroes down by resisting the changes we are implementing to enable completion of the establishment of NRA by putting in place its own high caliber workforce capable of mobilizing non-oil resources;

23. I hope all of you will agree with me that NRA is being looked upon by millions of our fellow citizens as one of the key institutions that will enable realization of the dream of the heroes of our expensive and bloody liberation struggle, both fallen and living;

24. Only in this way will you, the existing NRA staff, be able to take your rightful place in the heroic history of this nation as second liberators of our people, freeing them from a very low standard of living by enabling the Government to mobilize the resources needed to provide them with the public services they deserve - education, water, health, electricity, roads, law and order, and many others comparable to our brothers and sisters in the region;

25. By your recent non-oil revenue collection performance, you have already demonstrated your commitment to the people of South Sudan, despite all the challenges you are facing – I urge you to carry on, don't be discouraged by the few elements that are bent on disrupting our reforms for their own

personal interests; say no to them, do not betray the current struggle for the economic liberation of South Sudan;

26. **In recognition of your efforts, the government has increased resource allocation to NRA, and I would like to take this opportunity to direct the CG to develop a proposal for paying a second bonus for this fiscal year if you maintain your excellent performance this month, as well as a proposal to improve your remuneration package for the coming fiscal year 2023/2024;**

27. I urge you, as leaders in your respective areas, to ensure that you clearly understand what the NRA is doing, how it will be done, and why, so that you can, from now on, explain to your subordinates and gain full support from everyone for these reforms championed by H.E. Gen. Salva Kiir Mayardit, President of the Republic, and his assistants who are responsible for overseeing our work - H.E. Prof. James Wani Igga, Vice President for the Economic Cluster and Hon. Dr. Dier Tong Ngor, Minister of Finance and Planning;

28. I hope that during our plenary talks following the break, you will have the opportunity to seek clarification as needed and to share suggestions and insights on how we may efficiently move the NRA ahead from its current baby stage in compliance with our legislation.

THANK YOU SO MUCH